

Desk Drawer Story Sequence Card Pack

Sixteen paper sequence cards turn pretend drawer objects into clear beginning-middle-ending story order.

Audience: Families, homeschool groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable story sequence cards plus adult guide tools, sequence routines, take-home sequence slips, and optional share prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline story practice.

\$39

Included

- 16 printable desk-drawer sequence cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional sequence-card safety notes
- Sequence coaching moves
- Privacy and family handoff notes
- Pack reset notes
- Six adult-led sequence routines
- Ten take-home sequence slips
- Eight optional share prompts
- Provider-ready PDF and ZIP artifact

Sequence move coaching

Before the session

- Print and cut the desk drawer sequence cards before the writer arrives.
- Choose six to ten cards for the group size and place the rest aside.
- Set blank paper, pencils, blank slips, and a small envelope or box to stand in for the pretend drawer.
- Explain that the drawer objects are fictional paper clues used to build a made-up story order.
- Start with one adult example so writers see how beginning, middle, and ending cards line up.

Privacy and safety notes

- Keep all work on paper and offline with the adult leader or family folder.
- Use invented names, pretend places, and made-up drawer objects.
- Redirect any personal or narrow real-life detail into a broad invented detail before writing.
- A writer may point to one card or share one invented word instead of reading aloud.
- Skip any prompt that stops feeling gentle, invented, paper-only, or adult-led.

Paper sequence setup

- Place the selected cards face down in a small envelope, tray, or pretend desk drawer.
- Pull single cards and set each into one of three zones: beginning, middle, or ending.
- Let writers move cards before writing so the sequence can change without erasing.
- Keep blank bridge slips nearby for one missing event between two cards.
- Save skipped cards in a later pile so the session keeps moving.

Family handoff

- Send one ordered card row, one blank bridge slip, or one short fiction sentence.
- Tell family adults the task is event order practice, not a mark of writing ability.
- Invite one gentle paper retell using first, next, then, and finally.
- Ask families to keep examples fictional and offline.
- Return unfinished cards in a folder for the next adult-led session.

Story sequence coaching

- Ask what has to happen before this card can make sense.
- Use concrete transition words: first, next, then, after that, because, and finally.
- When a writer stalls, offer two possible spots for the card and let the writer choose.
- Point to the paper order before asking for another sentence.
- Finish with one quick retell from left to right before the final writing round.

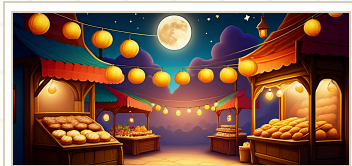
Reset

- Collect selected cards, blank slips, and draft pages.
- Return finished pages to the writer or adult folder and recycle only scrap warm-ups.
- Sort cards by beginning, middle, ending, cause, and transition focus if useful.
- Shuffle the drawer stack before the next session.

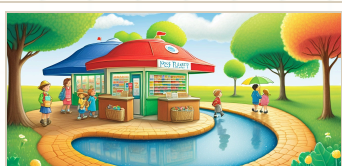
Use one paper sequence card at a time. Keep every choice broad, invented, and screen-free.

Sixteen story-sequence-card worlds

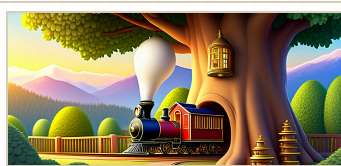
Pick a world image, then order one invented desk-drawer object into a story start.



AGES 6-8
Moon Muffin Market



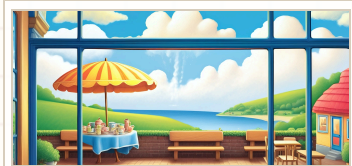
AGES 6-8
Puddle Planet Post Office



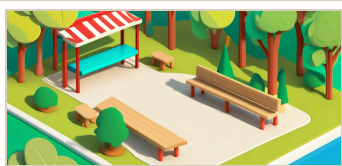
AGES 7-9
Buttonwood Library Train



AGES 7-9
Button Bakery Map Mix-Up



AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



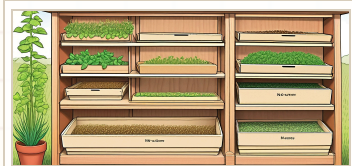
AGES 7-9
Pocket Park Notice Board



AGES 7-9
Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



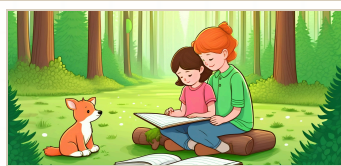
AGES 7-9
Acorn Avenue Errand Office



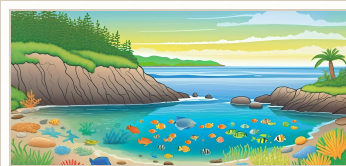
AGES 8-10
Seed Library Map Room



AGES 8-10
Rain Gauge Railway



AGES 8-10
Moss Message Observatory



AGES 8-10
Tidepool Timekeepers Lab



AGES 10-11
Revision River Ferry



AGES 10-11
Clue Label Tower Museum



AGES 10-11
Compass Craft Academy



AGES 10-11
Binding Day Boardwalk

Choose the paper sequence rhythm

Drawer Pull Warm-Up A gentle opening round for one writer or a small table. 1. Pull three cards from the pretend drawer. 2. Read each card aloud and place them in any order. 3. Ask which card has to happen first. 4. Write one sentence for each card using first, next, and then.	Beginning Middle Ending Sort Writers who need a clear story structure before drafting. 1. Draw six cards and spread them across the table. 2. Choose two cards for the beginning zone. 3. Choose two cards for the middle zone. 4. Choose two cards for the ending zone and retell the row aloud.
Cause Card Chain Practicing why one event leads to another. 1. Pull four cards and choose one card to start the chain. 2. Place the next card only after saying what caused it. 3. Move any card that does not connect yet to a later spot. 4. Write the sequence as four short story beats.	Missing Bridge Slip Fixing a story that skips ahead too quickly. 1. Read the ordered cards from left to right. 2. Stop where the story feels like it skipped a step. 3. Have the adult write one fictional bridge event on a blank slip. 4. Place the bridge slip in the gap and retell the sequence once.
Setting Path Row Showing how a character moves through a pretend drawer world. 1. Pick three fictional drawer spots such as tab corner, paperclip hill, or stamp stack. 2. Place a card at each setting spot. 3. Decide which spot the character visits first, next, and last. 4. Write one sentence that shows the move between each spot.	Ending Drawer Swap Revising an ending without rewriting the full story. 1. Keep the beginning and middle cards in their current order. 2. Pull two new ending cards from the pretend drawer. 3. Compare which ending fits the character's earlier choice. 4. Write the final two sentences using the chosen ending card.

Finish one story sequence later

ONE-CARD SLIP | BEGINNING SEQUENCE

First Drawer Clue

Pull three pretend drawer cards. Put the card that starts the made-up scene first, then write what _____ notices.

Family adult spots the beginning when _____ gives the story a clear first move.

CLOSING SLIP | ENDING SEQUENCE

Last Card Close

Choose a final pretend drawer object and write how the small story closes after _____.

The ending has arrived when _____ shows what changed last.

BECAUSE CHAIN | CAUSE AND EFFECT

Because Drawer Chain

Pick one paper drawer card that causes a change. Write what happens because _____ appears.

Cause and effect show up when _____ makes the next event happen.

EVENT ORDER SLIP | EVENT ORDER

Numbered Label Strip

Draw four paper label strips, number the events, and write which number belongs beside _____.

Check the event order by asking whether _____ happened before or after the other events.

SETTING ROW SLIP | SETTING SEQUENCE

Drawer Nook Path

Draw three pretend spots inside a desk drawer scene. Show where _____ appears first, next, and last.

The setting sequence helps the listener follow how _____ moves through the pretend drawer world.

BRIDGE SLIP | MIDDLE SEQUENCE

Middle Bridge Slip

Choose one card for the start and one for the end. Write the middle event that belongs between them: _____.

The middle works because _____ connects the first event to the last event.

FIRST-NEXT-FINALLY ROW | FIRST-NEXT-FINALLY

First Next Finally Row

Use three paper cards and write one First, one Next, and one Finally sentence about _____.

The first-next-finally row makes sense because _____ stays in the right order.

TRANSITION WORD SLIP | TRANSITION WORDS

Tab Word Trail

Write a three-sentence drawer story using after, then, and last. Put _____ in the sentence with your favorite transition word.

The transition word helps the listener understand where _____ belongs.

OBJECT PATH SLIP | OBJECT SEQUENCE

Object Stack Sort

Choose three fictional desk drawer objects. Arrange them by story job and explain why _____ goes in that spot.

The object sequence works because _____ has a clear place in the pretend drawer story.

PROBLEM-SOLUTION SLIP | PROBLEM-SOLUTION SEQUENCE

Folded Note Fix

Make a small pretend drawer problem, then add two steps that lead to a gentle solution. Write the solution step for _____.

The problem-solution sequence works because _____ comes after the problem and helps close the story.

Optional share prompts

- The card that belongs first is _____ because it gives the story a clear start.
- The card I moved to the middle was _____.
- The final card in my sequence is _____.
- One transition word that helped my order was _____.
- The drawer object that caused the next event was _____.
- The spot where my story needed a bridge slip was _____.
- My character chose _____ before the ending happened.
- The sequence I would try again starts with _____.

Moon Muffin Market Opening Order

Adult setup: Print the card, pull out three blank desk-drawer slips, and name the first market sound together: _____.

Fill the slips in order so the moon muffin stall opens before anything else happens: _____.



Moon Muffin Market

First prompt First, the moon muffin bell rings when _____.	Next prompt Next, the silver tray rolls toward _____.
Then prompt Then, the market helper notices _____.	Finally prompt Finally, the first paper wrapper closes around _____.
Transition prompt Transition prompt: Add one order word before the second event: _____.	Check back Check back: Point to the event that must happen first and explain why: _____.
Quiet option Quiet option: Number the three slips silently before writing one market word: _____.	

Take-home line: Retell the market opening with three new pretend drawer slips: _____.

Puddle Planet Parcel Path

Adult setup: Print the card, draw four small puddle boxes, and choose one made-up parcel job: _____.

Write the parcel trip step by step so each puddle box has one event: _____.



Puddle Planet Post Office

First prompt
First, the puddle parcel slides onto _____.

Next prompt
Next, the splash sorter sends it toward _____.

Then prompt
Then, the stamp puddle changes because _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the parcel reaches the desk drawer marked _____.

Transition prompt
Transition prompt: Choose one time word that helps the parcel move: _____.

Check back
Check back: Make sure the final stop could not happen before _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Tap the four puddle boxes in order before filling one blank: _____.

Take-home line: Try the parcel path again with a different pretend stamp: _____.

Buttonwood Library Train Ticket Row

Adult setup: Print the card, cut four paper ticket shapes, and choose the train's first shelf stop: _____.

Line up the tickets from first stop to last stop before writing the train scene: _____.



Buttonwood Library Train

First prompt
First, the Buttonwood Library Train arrives beside _____.

Next prompt
Next, the ticket reader checks _____.

Then prompt
Then, the shelf car opens and reveals _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the train rolls the book cart to _____.

Transition prompt
Transition prompt: Add a train-moving phrase between two tickets: _____.

Check back
Check back: Move any ticket that belongs earlier and name the clue: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Number the tickets with tiny dots before reading one sentence: _____.

Take-home line: Rebuild the library train row with four new paper tickets: _____.

Button Bakery Map Fix

Adult setup: Print the card, fold a scrap map into the desk drawer, and mark one wrong crumb path: _____.

Show how the map mix-up starts, grows clearer, and gets fixed in order: _____.



Button Bakery Map Mix-Up

First prompt
First, the button bakery map points to _____.

Next prompt
Next, the tray carrier follows the crumbs and finds _____.

Then prompt
Then, the baker spots the wrong label because _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the map is fixed when _____.

Transition prompt
Transition prompt: Add a bridge from problem to solution: _____.

Check back
Check back: Underline the step that actually solves the mix-up: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Trace the wrong crumb path with one finger before writing: _____.

Take-home line: Make a new folded bakery map with one different fix: _____.

Teacup Town Weather Change

Adult setup: Print the card, draw four little window panes, and choose the first pretend weather clue: _____.

Move through the panes in order so Teacup Town changes gently from start to finish: _____.



Teacup Town Weather Window

First prompt
First, the weather window shows _____.

Next prompt
Next, the cup-handle bridge begins to _____.

Then prompt
Then, the tiny town square changes when _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the window settles on _____.

Transition prompt
Transition prompt: Add a phrase that shows the weather changed: _____.

Check back
Check back: Circle the setting detail that changes after the first pane: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Sketch one weather mark in each pane before writing: _____.

Take-home line: Retell the weather-window sequence with four new pane clues: _____.

Pocket Park Notice Chain

Adult setup: Print the card, draw one small notice board, and invent a harmless paper notice together: _____.

Write what the notice says, what it causes, and how the park changes afterward: _____.



Pocket Park Notice Board

First prompt
First, the Pocket Park notice board announces _____.

Next prompt
Next, one bench-side helper reacts by _____.

Then prompt
Then, that choice causes _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the pocket park feels different because _____.

Transition prompt
Transition prompt: Add one cause-and-effect phrase before the third step: _____.

Check back
Check back: Draw an arrow from the notice to the effect it caused: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Point to each arrow in order before filling one blank: _____.

Take-home line: Make another pretend park notice and follow its effect chain: _____.

Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Adult setup: Place the card beside a pencil and one folded paper dock, then name the pretend ferry cargo together: _____.

Write what happens as the spoon ferry loads, crosses, pauses, and docks in order: _____.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

First prompt
First, the spoon ferry picks up _____ from the lunchbox dock.

Next prompt
Next, the harbor water makes the ferry _____.

Then prompt
Then, the crumb captain asks for _____ before docking.

Finally prompt
Finally, the ferry delivers _____ and the harbor settles.

Transition prompt
Add one crossing transition such as after that, soon, or at last before _____.

Check back
Check back and circle the event that could not happen before _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Sketch three small harbor boxes and label the last one _____.

Take-home line: Retell the spoon ferry trip in order, ending with _____.

Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Adult setup: Set out three scrap-paper errand tickets and tell the writer the Acorn Avenue office is invented: _____.

Write the errand in the order the acorn office handles it from drawer to stamp: _____.



Acorn Avenue Errand Office

First prompt
First, the acorn clerk opens the drawer and finds _____.

Next prompt
Next, the paperclip messenger carries _____ down Acorn Avenue.

Then prompt
Then, the leaf counter discovers _____ is in the wrong tray.

Finally prompt
Finally, the office stamps the errand with _____.

Transition prompt
Use an order word to show when _____ moves from one desk to the next.

Check back
Check back and fix one event if _____ happens too early.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Number four acorn-office moments and mark _____.

Take-home line: Retell the errand with first, next, then, and finally using _____.

Seed Library Map Room

Adult setup: Give the writer one index card as a pretend seed packet and one blank map square: _____.

Write a sequence where the labeled seed packet moves through shelves, drawers, and map marks: _____.



Seed Library Map Room

First prompt
First, the seed packet is placed on _____.

Next prompt
Next, the map room ladder, drawer, or stamp helps it move to _____.

Then prompt
Then, the packet is almost mixed up with _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the packet reaches the right map shelf and _____.

Transition prompt
Use a movement transition such as across, into, under, or beside before _____.

Check back
Check that the seed packet appears in every event, then add the missing spot: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Draw four tiny boxes and place the packet in box _____.

Take-home line: Save the finished card as a pretend library map label for _____.

Rain Gauge Railway

Adult setup: Lay a paper strip as the railway line and explain that the rain gauge, train, and station are pretend: _____.

Write a paper-only railway story where each event causes the next event in the chain: _____.



Rain Gauge Railway

First prompt
First, the rain gauge fills to the mark that says _____.

Next prompt
Next, because of that, the tiny railway conductor decides to _____.

Then prompt
Then, that choice causes the platform crew to _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the rain train arrives with _____.

Transition prompt
Add one cause transition such as because, so, or therefore before _____.

Check back
Check back and underline the event that causes _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Draw a cause-and-effect arrow from _____ to the last stop.

Take-home line: Tell the railway chain using one because sentence about _____.

Moss Message Observatory

Adult setup: Fold a paper telescope strip and invite the writer to imagine a desk-drawer observatory with invented rooms: _____.

Write the moss message sequence by adding one useful clue before the next clue appears: _____.



Moss Message Observatory

First prompt
First, the observatory lens notices _____ glowing in the moss.

Next prompt
Next, the moss message adds a smaller clue about _____.

Then prompt
Then, the watcher compares both clues and realizes _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the full moss message says _____.

Transition prompt
Add a clue-order transition such as next, later, or finally before _____.

Check back
Check back and remove any clue that explains _____ before the moss reveals it.

Quiet option
Quiet option: List four moss clues and put a box around _____.

Take-home line: Share the moss message in order, saving _____ for last.

Tidepool Shell Tray

Adult setup: Print the card, set out three small paper shells, and invite the writer to place them in story order: _____.

Use each blank to tell what the tidepool timekeepers do before the shell counter is reset: _____.



Tidepool Timekeepers Lab

First prompt
First, the tidepool timekeepers find a shell counter beside _____.

Next prompt
Next, the smallest timekeeper carries _____ to the sorting tray.

Then prompt
Then, the lab note changes because _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the shell counter is ready when _____.

Transition prompt
Add one sequence word that helps the reader move from one shell step to _____.

Check back
Check back: Does the first step clearly happen before _____?

Quiet option
Quiet option: Number the three shells silently and write only the middle step: _____.

Take-home line: Retell the tiny lab sequence at home with three paper marks: _____.

Revision River Ferry Docks

Adult setup: Print the card, draw four small ferry docks, and choose one plain draft sentence to send across: _____.

Build the crossing so the middle events explain how the sentence changes before it lands: _____.



Revision River Ferry

First prompt
First, the Revision River ferry leaves the drawer dock carrying _____.

Next prompt
Next, the ferry pauses when the draft sentence notices _____.

Then prompt
Then, the middle dock changes the sentence by adding _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the ferry reaches the far dock with _____.

Transition prompt
Add a transition phrase that shows the middle turn after _____.

Check back
Check back: Does the middle event make the final sentence easier to understand: _____?

Quiet option
Quiet option: Write only the ferry pause and the changed detail: _____.

Take-home line: Draw three ferry docks and label the strongest middle step: _____.

Clue Label Tower Trail

Adult setup: Print the card, sketch a tower of four blank labels, and remind the writer that every exhibit is fictional: _____.

Fill the labels so each clue gives the next clue room to make sense: _____.



Clue Label Tower Museum

First prompt
First, the lowest tower label names an exhibit shaped like _____.

Next prompt
Next, the second label adds the detail _____.

Then prompt
Then, the third label changes the clue by showing _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the top label reveals why _____.

Transition prompt
Add a transition phrase that connects the second clue to _____.

Check back
Check back: Does each clue appear before the clue that depends on _____?

Quiet option
Quiet option: List the four label details before writing the full trail: _____.

Take-home line: Turn four paper scraps into clue labels and order them around _____.

Compass Craft Choice Path

Adult setup: Print the card, draw a paper compass dial, and choose one academy craft choice to test: _____.

Show how each choice causes the next academy step inside the pretend academy page: _____.



Compass Craft Academy

First prompt
First, the apprentice chooses _____ for the compass center.

Then prompt
Then, the apprentice adjusts _____ because the pointer changes.

Transition prompt
Add a cause-and-effect transition such as because, so, or after: _____.

Quiet option
Quiet option: Draw one tiny cause arrow from the first choice to _____.

Next prompt
Next, that choice causes the compass mark to point toward _____.

Finally prompt
Finally, the finished compass helps the academy find _____.

Check back
Check back: Does each result grow from the choice before it: _____?

Take-home line: Name one cause and one result from your compass story: _____.

Binding Day Final Thread

Adult setup: Print the card, fold one scrap page like a tiny booklet, and choose a final paper problem: _____.

Write the ending steps so the boardwalk booklet closes the problem instead of starting a new one: _____.



Binding Day Boardwalk

First prompt
First, near the ending, the page keeper gathers _____.

Next prompt
Next, the keeper checks _____ before the ribbon is tied.

Then prompt
Then, the final page shows _____ has changed.

Finally prompt
Finally, the booklet closes beside _____.

Transition prompt
Add an ending transition that shows the last step follows _____.

Check back
Check back: Does the final moment answer something from earlier: _____?

Quiet option
Quiet option: Box the detail that feels like closure and write it here: _____.

Take-home line: Stack four scrap pages and name the final sequence: _____.